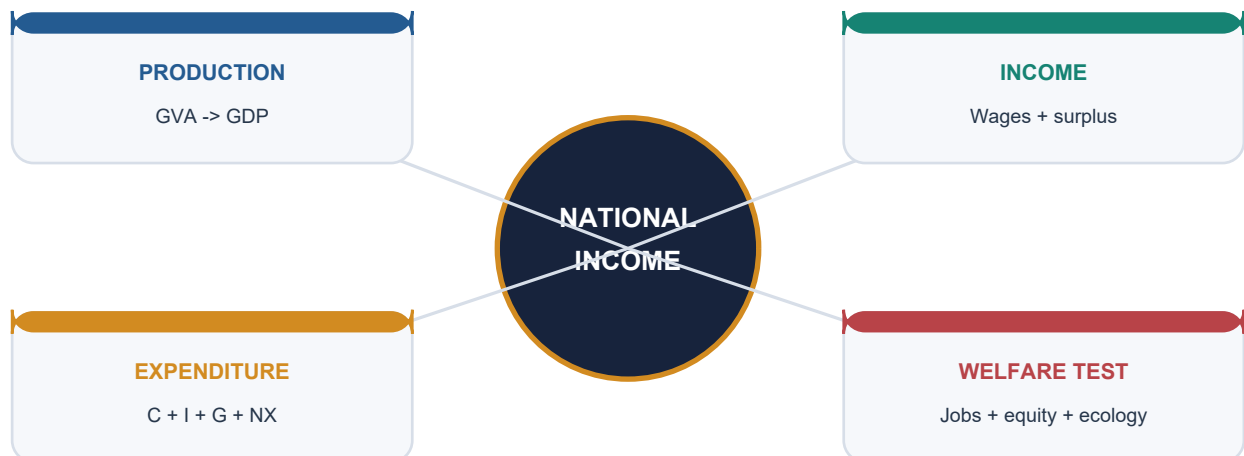


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Deterministic fallback visual: national income viewed through production, income, expenditure and welfare lenses.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

PYQ, practice and solved workbook

Verified/cross-owned Mains PYQ

PYQ 1 - UPSC GS-II 2025, Q4 - direct application

Verified neutral demand: Discuss the nature of the Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly after the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019, and briefly describe its powers and functions. **10 marks | 150 words | Primary owner: Union Territories; direct application here**

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] The post-2019 Jammu and Kashmir Assembly is an elected legislature of a Union Territory, not the legislature of a full State.

Named evidence: The Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 created J&K as a UT with a legislature and Ladakh as a UT without one. The J&K Assembly makes laws within the Act's permitted State-List and Concurrent-List fields, while public order and police remain outside its ordinary competence. It votes the budget, authorises expenditure, debates public policy and holds the Chief Minister-led Council of Ministers politically accountable.

Analysis: The Assembly restores representative government and regional voice after the 2019 reorganisation, but Parliament's overriding competence and the Lieutenant Governor/Union architecture make it weaker than a State legislature.

Current qualification: [CURRENT] Elections were held in 2024, but Statehood remains pending. [LIMIT] The 2023 Article 370 judgment recorded restoration at the earliest without fixing a deadline.

Verdict: J&K now has democratic self-government within a Union Territory framework; full federal parity awaits Statehood restoration.

Evidence chain: Reorganisation Act -> UT with legislature -> fields/exclusions -> financial/accountability functions -> 2024 election -> pending Statehood.

Routed Prelims demands - provenance without invented answer letters

Prelims route 1 - 2024 GS-I Q70

Verified neutral demand: Composition of the North Eastern Council.

Doctrinal solution

- [FACT] NEC is statutory under the North Eastern Council Act, 1971.
- [FACT] It includes Governors and Chief Ministers of the region's States and three presidential nominees.
- [FACT] The Union Home Minister and DoNER Minister hold the current ex-officio leadership roles under the amended framework.
- [LIMIT] NEC is not an Article 371 constitutional body.

Elimination rule: Reject options treating NEC as a Sixth Schedule council or Article 371 committee.

Prelims route 2 - 2022 GS-I Q73 - cross-owned

Verified neutral demand: Consequences of Fifth Schedule status for tribal areas.

Doctrinal solution

- [FACT] President declares Scheduled Areas.
- [FACT] Governor reports annually and may make land/money-lending protective regulations subject to presidential assent.
- [FACT] Union may issue directions to the State.
- [FACT] Tribes Advisory Council is advisory.

Elimination rule: Do not confuse Fifth Schedule supervised protection with Sixth Schedule autonomous councils.

Prelims route 3 - 2025 GS-I Q56 - cross-owned

Verified neutral demand: Executive power and Union role in a Fifth Schedule Scheduled Area.

Doctrinal solution

- [FACT] State executive power continues in Scheduled Areas.
- [FACT] Union executive power extends to giving directions concerning administration.
- [LIMIT] This is not automatic Union takeover or direct day-to-day administration.

Elimination rule: Reject both "no Union role" and "automatic Union administration."

Prelims route 4 - 2026 GS-I Q57 - provisional cross-owner

Verified neutral demand: Constitutional safeguards, schedules, taxation and local representation for SCs/STs.

Doctrinal solution

- [FACT] Fifth/Sixth Schedules operate under Article 244; Sixth Schedule councils possess specified taxation powers.
- [FACT] Legislative and local-body reservations arise from separate constitutional provisions.
- [LIMIT] The local 2026 key is provisional; no official answer letter is inferred.

Elimination rule: Do not attribute Sixth Schedule fiscal powers to a Fifth Schedule Tribes Advisory Council.

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Part location

Articles 370 and 371 provisions are located in:

A. Part XXI. B. Part III. C. Part X only. D. Ninth Schedule.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Part XXI contains temporary, transitional and special provisions.

OM2. Article 370 status

The most accurate description is:

A. deleted entirely from the printed Constitution. B. rendered inoperative through the 2019 process. C. fully operational after 2023. D. converted into Article 371.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Inoperability is not textual deletion.

OM3. Article 35A source

Article 35A entered through:

A. an ordinary J&K statute. B. the First Amendment. C. the 1954 Presidential Order. D. a Supreme Court judgment.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] It was not a Parliament-passed constitutional amendment.

OM4. Reorganisation

The 2019 Act created:

A. two full States. B. J&K State and Ladakh State. C. one UT without legislature. D. J&K UT with legislature and Ladakh UT without legislature.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Effective from 31 October 2019.

OM5. 2023 judgment

The Court held Article 370 was:

A. temporary. B. a permanent Basic Structure provision. C. outside judicial review. D. a treaty.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The Court upheld the abrogation.

OM6. Internal sovereignty

The Court held J&K:

A. retained treaty sovereignty. B. retained no internal sovereignty distinct from other States. C. could veto every Union law. D. remained a dominion.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Accession and constitutional integration were controlling.

OM7. Constituent Assembly

The Court held presidential Article 370(3) power:

A. expired in 1957. B. required a referendum. C. survived dissolution of the J&K Constituent Assembly. D. belonged to the Governor.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Recommendation was not a continuing precondition.

OM8. Statehood question

Which is accurate?

A. Statehood was restored in 2024. B. Court set 2025 as deadline. C. Court finally upheld every State-to-UT conversion. D. Statehood remains pending and no fixed judicial deadline was imposed.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [CURRENT/LIMIT] The Union assurance was recorded.

OM9. J&K Assembly

The present J&K Assembly belongs to:

A. a Union Territory with legislature. B. a full State. C. an autonomous district. D. a Sixth Schedule region.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Statehood is pending.

OM10. Ladakh

Ladakh currently is:

A. a State. B. a Union Territory without legislature. C. a Sixth Schedule autonomous State. D. governed under Article 371A.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Demands have not changed constitutional status.

OM11. Article 371 States

The Article 371 family covers special provisions for:

A. all States. B. only North-Eastern States. C. 12 States. D. every Union Territory.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The family extends from Maharashtra/Gujarat to Karnataka and multiple NE States.

OM12. Article 371

Development boards for Vidarbha/Marathwada and Saurashtra/Kutch arise under:

A. 371A. B. 371D. C. 371J only. D. Article 371.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] It concerns Maharashtra and Gujarat.

OM13. Nagaland

Article 371A applies to:

A. Nagaland. B. Mizoram. C. Assam. D. Manipur.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] It protects Naga custom, land and specified justice fields.

OM14. Assam committee

The Tribal Areas committee provision is:

A. 371C. B. 371B. C. 371H. D. 371I.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 371B concerns Assam.

OM15. Manipur

Hill Areas Committee is associated with:

A. 371F. B. 371G. C. 371C. D. 371J.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] It includes Governor special responsibility/reporting.

OM16. AP and Telangana

Equitable local opportunity in public employment and education is primarily:

A. 371A. B. 371F. C. 371I. D. 371D.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] The framework applies to Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

OM17. Sikkim

Article 371F concerns:

A. Sikkim. B. Goa. C. Karnataka. D. Arunachal Pradesh.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] It accompanied Sikkim's integration.

OM18. Mizoram

Customary-law and land consent protection is found in:

A. 371B. B. 371G. C. 371H. D. 371I.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 371G resembles 371A in protected subjects.

OM19. Arunachal Pradesh

Governor law-and-order responsibility is under:

A. 371D. B. 371F. C. 371H. D. 371J.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The Assembly minimum is also 30.

OM20. Goa

Article 371I provides principally:

A. land-law consent. B. a Hill Areas Committee. C. local cadres. D. minimum Assembly strength of 30.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] It is a narrow institutional provision.

OM21. Karnataka

Article 371J concerns:

A. Kalyana Karnataka regional development and local opportunity. B. Saurashtra only. C. Naga customary law. D. Goa's Assembly.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Inserted by the 98th Amendment.

OM22. Strongest consent shields

Which pair requires Assembly decision for specified custom/land parliamentary laws?

A. 371B and 371C. B. 371A and 371G. C. 371H and 371I. D. 371 and 371J.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Nagaland and Mizoram.

OM23. Fifth Schedule

Scheduled Areas are declared by:

A. Governor. B. State Assembly. C. President. D. Tribes Advisory Council.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Consultation with Governor occurs where relevant.

OM24. Sixth Schedule States

The correct group is:

A. Nagaland, Manipur, Arunachal, Sikkim. B. all NE States. C. Assam, Nagaland, Mizoram, Manipur. D. Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Use AMTM.

OM25. Fifth Schedule institution

The advisory institution is:

A. Tribes Advisory Council. B. Autonomous District Council. C. North Eastern Council. D. Inter-State Council.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] TAC does not legislate.

OM26. Sixth Schedule

Autonomous District Councils may exercise:

A. no taxing power. B. specified legislative, judicial and fiscal powers. C. only advisory functions. D. presidential election powers.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Powers are limited to Schedule subjects.

OM27. Article 371 versus Sixth Schedule

Which is correct?

A. They are the same mechanism. B. Sixth Schedule is part of Article 371A. C. They are distinct constitutional mechanisms. D. Article 371 applies only to autonomous councils.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Part XXI differs from Article 244 schedules.

OM28. Ladakh demand

As of 18 August 2026:

A. Ladakh is a State. B. Sixth Schedule automatically applies. C. Article 371K protects it. D. Statehood/Sixth Schedule demands remain unenacted.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [CURRENT] No constitutional change has been enacted.

OM29. NEC

The North Eastern Council is:

A. a statutory body. B. an Article 371 body. C. a Sixth Schedule district council. D. a constitutional court.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] It arises under the NEC Act, 1971.

OM30. NEC membership

The NEC framework includes:

A. only Governors. B. Governors, Chief Ministers and presidential nominees. C. only MPs. D. Autonomous Council chiefs only.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Ex-officio Union leadership was added under the amended framework.

OM31. Differentiated rights

The strongest constitutional defence is:

A. every difference is permanent. B. uniformity is unconstitutional. C. tailored protection can advance substantive equality and integration. D. special provisions create separate sovereignty.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Purpose and proportionality justify differentiation.

OM32. Basic Structure

Which is accurate?

A. Every Article 371 clause is unamendable. B. Federalism is not Basic Structure. C. Part XXI is outside review. D. Federalism is Basic Structure, but individual special provisions are not automatically unamendable.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT/ANALYSIS] Review concerns the federal principle and amendment effect.

OM33. Article 371A scope

Its Assembly shield applies:

A. only to four specified subject groups. B. to every Union law. C. only to taxation. D. only during emergency.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] It is strong but subject-specific.

OM34. Article 371E

It empowers Parliament concerning:

A. district councils. B. a Central University in Andhra Pradesh. C. Goa Assembly strength. D. J&K Statehood.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Do not confuse with 371D local-opportunity rules.

OM35. Article 370 judgment caution

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Court deleted Article 370 text. B. Court fixed a Statehood date. C. Court upheld abrogation but did not finally adjudicate the UT-conversion validity. D. Court restored Article 35A.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT/LIMIT] The Union assurance made a final ruling on J&K conversion unnecessary.

OM36. Asymmetric federalism

The best description is:

A. multiple sovereignties outside India. B. identical rules for all regions. C. temporary emergency alone. D. constitutionally tailored autonomy/protection within one Union.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Difference operates inside constitutional unity.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

R1. Status trap

Article 370 was:

A. rendered inoperative, not textually deleted. B. moved to Part III. C. replaced by Sixth Schedule. D. restored in 2024.

Answer: A.

Remedy: Separate printed text from legal operability.

R2. Judgment trap

The 2023 Court described Article 370 as:

A. permanent sovereignty guarantee. B. temporary. C. ordinary statute. D. treaty immune from change.

Answer: B.

Remedy: Use the exact holding.

R3. Statehood trap

J&K Statehood:

A. was restored with elections. B. has a judicial deadline. C. remains pending. D. is barred forever.

Answer: C.

Remedy: Elections and Statehood are separate.

R4. Ladakh trap

Ladakh:

A. has an Assembly. B. is under Article 371A. C. is already Sixth Schedule. D. remains a UT without legislature.

Answer: D.

Remedy: Demands are not enacted status.

R5. Nagaland trap

The land/custom shield belongs to:

A. Article 371A. B. 371B. C. 371C. D. 371I.

Answer: A.

Remedy: A = Nagaland; G = Mizoram.

R6. Committee trap

Assam's Tribal Areas Committee is:

A. 371C. B. 371B. C. 371H. D. Fifth Schedule TAC.

Answer: B.

Remedy: Article 371B is an Assembly committee, not the Fifth Schedule TAC.

R7. Local-opportunity trap

AP/Telangana provision:

A. 371F. B. 371J. C. 371D. D. 371I.

Answer: C.

Remedy: D = local cadres/opportunity.

R8. Schedule trap

Sixth Schedule applies in:

A. all tribal States. B. ten Fifth Schedule States. C. Ladakh automatically. D. Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

Answer: D.

Remedy: AMTM.

R9. Fifth Schedule declaration

Scheduled Areas are declared by:

A. President. B. Governor. C. Parliament alone. D. TAC.

Answer: A.

Remedy: Governor has reporting/regulation roles, not declaration.

R10. NEC trap

NEC is:

A. constitutional. B. statutory. C. judicial. D. a State legislature.

Answer: B.

Remedy: NEC Act, 1971.

R11. Equality trap

Special provisions may be defended because:

A. every resident has separate citizenship. B. federalism requires secession. C. tailored safeguards can serve substantive equality. D. Article 14 never applies.

Answer: C.

Remedy: Different treatment needs a legitimate protective/developmental purpose.

R12. Source trap

Article 35A came from:

A. Reorganisation Act. B. 36th Amendment. C. Article 371J. D. 1954 Presidential Order.

Answer: D.

Remedy: It was not enacted through Article 368.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. "Asymmetric federalism strengthens Indian unity through constitutional difference."

Discuss. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] Indian unity is not based on institutional uniformity; Part XXI uses tailored guarantees to integrate historically and culturally distinct regions.

Named evidence: Articles 371A and 371G protect customary law and land through Assembly consent. Articles 371 and 371J address regional imbalance. Articles 371B and 371C create tribal/hill representation, while Article 371F managed Sikkim's integration.

Analysis: These provisions reduce fears of cultural absorption, protect vulnerable resources and make Union membership compatible with local autonomy.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Asymmetry may create insider-outsider barriers or patronage if safeguards lack accountability.

Verdict: It strengthens unity when protection is purposeful, locally participatory and reviewable. Constitutional difference is then an instrument of integration, not separate sovereignty.

M2. Critically examine the 2019 changes to Article 370 in light of the 2023 Supreme Court judgment. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] The 2019 process ended Article 370's operative autonomy; the 2023 Constitution Bench upheld the result by treating the Article as temporary and presidential power as continuing.

Mechanism: C.O. 272 applied the Constitution and altered the interpretive route; parliamentary action during President's Rule supported C.O. 273's Article 370(3) declaration. The Reorganisation Act created J&K and Ladakh Union Territories.

Judgment: *In re Article 370* held that J&K retained no separate internal sovereignty, Article 370 was temporary and the President's power survived dissolution of the Constituent Assembly. It found it unnecessary to make the contested Article 367 route essential to validity.

Critique: Integration and uniform rights are advanced; however, using President's Rule when the affected State had no elected voice raises federal-consent concerns.

Qualification: [LIMIT] The Court did not finally decide the validity of converting J&K into a UT; Statehood remains pending.

Verdict: Abrogation is judicially settled, but federal legitimacy requires timely Statehood restoration and representative consultation.

M3. Compare Articles 371A and 371G. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Articles 371A and 371G are the strongest Part XXI identity safeguards because specified parliamentary laws do not automatically apply without State Assembly decision.

Common fields: religious/social practices, customary law and procedure, customary administration of civil/criminal justice, and land ownership/transfer are protected in Nagaland and Mizoram respectively.

Differences: Article 371A contains Nagaland-specific Tuensang and law-and-order arrangements; Article 371G is tied to Mizoram's settlement framework and fixes a minimum Assembly strength of 40.

Analysis: Both convert cultural protection into a legal consent mechanism rather than a merely advisory promise.

Qualification: [LIMIT] The shield is subject-specific, not a general veto over Parliament.

Verdict: They demonstrate integration through protected custom and land, with State legislatures acting as constitutional consent institutions.

M4. Does differentiated regional protection conflict with single citizenship and equality? Examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] Special regional rights create differentiated entitlements but do not create separate Indian citizenships.

Conflict: Land, employment and customary-law protections may restrict equal mobility and produce insider-outsider distinctions. Historical Article 35A and current Articles 371A/G are prominent examples.

Justification: Formal sameness can expose small indigenous communities and backward regions to dispossession or permanent disadvantage. Articles 371, 371J and tribal schedules pursue substantive equality, identity and balanced development.

Constitutional balance: Article 14 permits reasonable classification, federalism permits tailored design and judicial review controls arbitrariness. Local minorities and accountability must also be protected.

Qualification: [LIMIT] A protective purpose does not justify every restriction indefinitely.

Verdict: Differentiation is compatible with single citizenship where it is constitutionally authorised, proportionate and connected to vulnerability; it becomes problematic when it hardens into unreviewable exclusion.

M5. Compare Article 371 protections with the Fifth and Sixth Schedules. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] All three protect diversity, but they operate through different units and institutions.

Article 371 family: State-specific arrangements in Part XXI. They range from development boards and local reservations to Assembly consent over custom and land.

Fifth Schedule: Article 244 creates supervised protection in Scheduled Areas. The President declares areas; the Governor reports, modifies laws and makes land/money-lending regulations subject to presidential assent; the TAC advises.

Sixth Schedule: Autonomous district/regional councils in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram exercise specified legislative, judicial and fiscal powers.

Analysis: Article 371 protects through the State Constitution relationship; the Fifth protects through guardianship; the Sixth decentralises self-government.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Overlap of geography or purpose does not merge legal powers.

Verdict: The choice between the mechanisms reflects the depth of autonomy sought: tailored State protection, supervised Scheduled-Area administration or autonomous tribal government.

M6. Assess the constitutional and political case for Sixth Schedule protection in Ladakh. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [CURRENT] Ladakh's Sixth Schedule demand seeks enforceable protection for tribal identity, land, jobs, ecology and local decision-making after its conversion into a UT without legislature.

Case for: A predominantly tribal and ecologically fragile region faces rapid development and limited representative law-making. Autonomous councils with specified legislative and fiscal powers could deepen local consent and protect resources.

Concerns: Ladakh's strategic border location, existing Hill Councils, inter-regional Leh-Kargil differences and the Sixth Schedule's original north-eastern design require careful institutional adaptation.

Alternatives: Statehood, a UT legislature, stronger Hill Councils or Article 371-type safeguards may address some demands, but differ in legal strength and scope.

Current status: [CURRENT] No Sixth Schedule or Statehood change has been enacted by 18 August 2026.

Verdict: The demand deserves negotiated constitutional protection, but the model should preserve national security while granting real land, employment and democratic safeguards rather than symbolic consultation.

M7. "The unresolved Statehood question is now more important than the settled Article 370 question." Comment. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [ANALYSIS] The legality of Article 370's inoperability is settled by the 2023 judgment, while J&K's federal status remains institutionally unfinished.

Settled dimension: The Court held Article 370 temporary, rejected separate internal sovereignty and upheld the presidential declaration. Elections were directed and held in 2024.

Unresolved dimension: J&K remains a UT. The Court recorded the Union's assurance of Statehood at the earliest but fixed no deadline and avoided deciding the validity of the State-to-UT conversion.

Why it matters: Statehood affects federal representation, legislative competence, executive authority, policing and the symbolic equality of J&K with other States. An elected UT Assembly restores democracy but not full federal autonomy.

Counterpoint: Security, administrative transition and parliamentary control may justify sequencing.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Pending restoration does not reopen Article 370 automatically.

Verdict: The constitutional task has shifted from adjudicating special status to completing representative federal normalisation through a clear, credible Statehood process.

M8. Evaluate whether regional-development clauses under Articles 371 and 371J deliver substantive federal equality. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model answer

Claim: [FACT] Articles 371 and 371J address inequality within States rather than autonomy between Union and State.

Design: Article 371 supports development boards, reporting, equitable development expenditure and opportunity for identified regions of Maharashtra and Gujarat. Article 371J creates a development board and local education/employment measures for Kalyana Karnataka.

Strength: Constitutional recognition prevents backward regions from disappearing inside State-wide averages and can direct funds, seats and posts toward persistent disadvantage.

Weakness: Boards may become advisory, data may be opaque, local reservation can face implementation disputes and constitutional labels cannot substitute for budgets or administrative capacity.

Reform: publish region-wise outcome indicators, link allocations to deprivation, conduct independent audits, preserve merit through capacity-building and involve local elected bodies.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Region-based preference must remain proportionate and periodically evaluated.

Verdict: These clauses can realise substantive federal equality only when constitutional recognition is converted into measurable development rather than permanent political symbolism.